

## WORKSHEET

# The Firstfruit and the Honest Weight

**Torah:** Deuteronomy 26:1–29:9 · **Haftarah:** Isaiah 60:1–22 · **Gospel:** Matthew 4:13–24

*In Ki Tavo you bring the first of the harvest back because all is gift — down to the heart to understand (29:4); and the joy in it (28:47) is no atmosphere but the test of whether you still remember Who gave it.*

## How to use this sheet

Work from top to bottom: first observe (A1), then weigh (A2), then diagnose (A3), and only then summarize (A4). The direction — received or grasped — is the horizon, not the starting point.

## Basic details

→ *First fill in the basics: which passage, which haftarah, any flanking reading with its status, and for whom you are making this.*

**Parashah / delimitation:** Ki Tavo — Deuteronomy 26:1–29:9

**Haftarah / ritual place:** Isaiah 60:1–22 (sixth comfort sabbath; sheva de-nechemta)

**Flanking reading and status:** Matthew 4:13–24 — New Testament mirroring, confessionally used (not as peshat).

**Target group and desired form:** Study group / congregation · a compact study and a spoken reading.

## A1. Text blocks and peshat

→ *Read block by block. Note first what it says, then the key word or contrast, and only then a genuine open question — not steerable toward an answer you already*

want.

| Text block | What does it say?<br>(peshat)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Key words /<br>contrast                                                 | Open question                                           |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 26:1–11    | When you come into the land, take the first of all the fruit in a basket, go to the chosen place, and speak the confession: ‘a Syrian ready to perish was my father’ (Egypt, exodus, land).<br>‘Rejoice in every good thing.’<br>The third-year tithe for Levite, stranger, fatherless and widow (‘I have hearkened’); and the mutual declaration: you have said the LORD is your God, the LORD has said you are His own people (am segulah). | firstfruits · arami<br>oved avi · rejoice ·<br>received → given<br>back | Why does a story belong with the bringing of the fruit? |
| 26:12–19   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | I have hearkened ·<br>you / the LORD<br>have said · am<br>segulah       | Who speaks first here — you, or God?                    |
| 27:11–26   | Gerizim and Ebal; twelve curses, mostly over hidden sins (the graven image in secret, misleading the blind), each                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | hidden sins ·<br>‘Amen’ · wholeness<br>(inside = outside)               | Why curses precisely over what no one sees?             |

| Text block                        | What does it say?<br>(peshat)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Key words /<br>contrast                               | Open question                                                  |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                   | answered with<br>‘Amen’.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                       |                                                                |
|                                   | Blessing on<br>obedience; the long,<br>swelling curse on<br>disobedience; and<br>the key: ‘because                                                                                                                                                                                     | blessing / curse ·                                    | How can abundance                                              |
| <b>28 (hinge 28:47)</b>           | thou servedst not the joyless service · ‘for become the root of<br>LORD thy God with the abundance’<br>joyfulness and with<br>gladness of heart,<br>for the abundance of<br>all things’ (28:47).<br>You have seen it all<br>— the signs, the<br>wonders, the forty<br>years — ‘yet the |                                                       | the curse?                                                     |
|                                   | LORD hath not<br>given you an heart<br>to perceive, and eyes<br>to see, and ears to<br>hear, unto this day’<br>(29:4).                                                                                                                                                                 | ‘no heart to<br>perceive’ · gift ·<br>‘unto this day’ | If even the heart is<br>given, what remains<br>of ‘achieving’? |
| <b>Isa. 60:1 / Matt.<br/>4:16</b> | ‘Arise, shine; for thy<br>light is come’ — the<br>light rises upon you<br>and the nations<br>come to it. And: ‘the<br>people which sat in<br>darkness saw great<br>light’ (citing Isa. 9).                                                                                             | received light<br>reflected back · the<br>eyes open   | How does ‘arise,<br>shine’ relate to ‘no<br>heart’ in 29:4?    |

## A2. Connecting hypotheses

→ *Formulate two readings the text could carry, and choose with the test: which explains the most data with the least force?*

**Hypothesis 1 (one axis):** the center of gravity is the Will axis alone — the parashah is covenant response: bring, confess, remember, obey, rejoice, answer ‘Amen’. The gift side then stays background.

**Hypothesis 2 (relation):** the center of gravity is the relation between Source and Will — all is gift (down to the heart, 29:4), and precisely therefore the response is thankfulness, not achievement. The firstfruits embody receiving-and-giving-back in one act.

**Which explains the most data with the least force?** Hypothesis 2. Hypothesis 1 sees the response, but makes am segulah (26:18, God pronounces the status) and 29:4 (the heart is given) inexplicable. The relation reading binds the firstfruits, 28:47 and 29:4 into one figure.

**What would refute this reading?** If the firstfruits (front), 28:47 (mid-curse) and 29:4 (end) turned out not to be one coherent figure but loose rules, the center of gravity would lie elsewhere — for instance at the integrity of 27–28 (Coherence).

## A3. Four axes

→ *Fill in the text anchors and a short diagnosis per axis. Leave the last column for what your reading does not smooth over — the open anomaly.*

| Axis   | Text anchors                               | Diagnosis                                                                           | Open anomaly                                     |
|--------|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Source | 26:9–10 (land, fruit)                      | Bearing. All is received — land, fruit, being a people,                             | Why does God at times withhold the heart (29:4)? |
|        | · 26:18 (am segulah)<br>· 29:4 (the heart) | down to the heart to understand. The human receives before he brings anything back. |                                                  |

| Axis       | Text anchors                                                                                   | Diagnosis                                                                                                                                                                   | Open anomaly                                                                             |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Will       | 26:2 (bring the first)<br>· 26:5–10 (confess)<br>26:11 (rejoice) ·<br>27:15–26 (‘Amen’)        | Bearing — meets<br>Source in<br>thankfulness.<br>Covenant response:<br>· bringing,<br>· confessing,<br>remembering,<br>obeying, rejoicing<br>— as answer, not as<br>source. | Where does<br>‘thankful service’<br>turn into ‘my own<br>strength’ (28:47; cf.<br>8:17)? |
|            |                                                                                                | Supporting; honest<br>as second pole.<br>Wholeness — no<br>gap between hidden<br>and open;<br>blessing/curse as a<br>coherence of<br>consequences.                          | Does 27–28 pull the<br>center of gravity<br>away from<br>thankfulness, or<br>serve it?   |
| Trajectory | 26:1 (‘when you<br>come into the land’)<br>· 29:5 (forty years) ·<br>29:4 (‘unto this<br>day’) | Thin. From exodus<br>to land to ‘this day’<br>— pointing forward,<br>not the core.                                                                                          | Is ‘unto this day’ a<br>limit, or a promise<br>still opening?                            |

*Reactivity: weak; not foregrounded (‘I have not transgressed nor forgotten’, 26:13, is response, not reaction). Note it as observation, and do not place it as the motor under the reading.*

## A4. Movement

→ *Summarize the movement: what does the text unmask, what frame does it put in its place, what response follows — and capture it in one core sentence.*

**What is unmasked?** The joyless, forgetful service ‘for the abundance’ (28:47) — the gift cut loose from the remembering of the Giver; ‘my own strength has gotten

me this' (cf. 8:17).

**What frame does the text put in its place?** Thankful remembrance: bring the first back with the story of grace on your lips (arami oved avi), and rejoice — because all is gift, down to the heart (29:4).

**What concrete response and formation follow?** Give the first back, not the leftover; remember the story of gift aloud; share with Levite, stranger, fatherless and widow; and seek the joy as a test — do I serve out of remembrance, or out of habit?

**Core sentence: Bringing the first back — serving out of what you received; the joy is the test of whether you still remember Who gave it.**

***Horizon** (not this week's theme, but the ground): beneath all this lies the one question — received or grasped. The firstfruits are the received-form; the 'my own strength' service the grasped-form. In the gospel the light rises (Isa. 60; Matt. 4:16) and the eyes 29:4 still withheld open in Yeshua — the given heart, embodied.*